

# Ethan Charles Stuart

Los Angeles, CA • (415) 419 - 7630 • ethan.c.stuart@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/ethan-stuart • github.com/ethancstuart • ethancstuart.com

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI and software product leader who ships. Lead a matrixed 40+ person data and AI product engineering organization at Disney Studios — AI applications, agent workflows, and the enterprise data platforms beneath them — with time from spec to shipped cut from roughly four months to about one.

Built two enterprise data platforms 0→ 1 in financial services and restaurants, and scaled a third in entertainment.

Run the same AI-native operating model solo on a portfolio of production software: agent-reviewed specs, decision logs, shipped products with real users.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

**AI-Native Operating Model:** AI Coding Tool Deployment | Agent-Augmented Product Workflows | AI-Fluency Hiring | Cross-Functional AI Enablement Program Leadership

**Leadership:** Organizational Design | Operating Model Development | Strategic Planning & Roadmap Execution | Change Management & Platform Adoption | Executive Stakeholder Management | Matrixed Organizations

**Enterprise Data:** Platform Modernization | Customer Data Platforms (CDP) | Data Governance & Lineage | Event Instrumentation & Data Contracts | Experimentation | Feature Stores | Predictive Analytics

**AI & Engineering:** LLMs | Conversational AI | Multi-Agent Systems | Agent Workflows | MCP | Semantic Search & RAG | Vector Databases & Embeddings | Evals | LLMOps | React | TypeScript | Next.js | Python | Supabase | Claude API

## EXPERIENCE

### The Walt Disney Company | Studio Technology and Operations Senior Manager, AI & Data Products

July 2025 — Present

- Matrixed 40+ person org • 15-person team of FTEs, contractors, and SOW resources across 10 product pods • briefs executives monthly
- Lead product development across React applications, conversational AI, agent workflows, chatbot-as-a-service, and just-in-time agent access — user-facing experiences and the reusable platform capabilities beneath them.
- Cut time from spec to shipped from roughly four months to about one by establishing an AI-native operating model — AI coding tools as standard at 100% weekly active PM adoption (telemetry-tracked), agent-augmented PM workflows, AI-fluency hiring, and AI-built internal tooling including an in-daily-use PM portal.
- Established the Studio Technology and Operations data-product function as its first full-time data-product hire; scaled it to 10 product pods and defined the product operating model.
- Assumed day-to-day platform leadership following a director-level departure — hiring, performance management, vendors, contracts, and executive briefings; lead capital-investment prioritization and partner on annual planning.
- Multiplied platform stakeholders ~10x and brought on 10+ new partner groups through stakeholder-led change management, taking the platform enterprise-wide.
- Own the product roadmap and portfolio for the studio's Snowflake and Databricks platforms — forecasting, content valuation, production modeling, and piracy intelligence — partnering with the engineering leader responsible for platform execution.
- Established enterprise data governance, metadata, security, and quality frameworks across the full footprint; production pipelines run under documented freshness and quality SLOs.
- Shipped semantic search and talk-to-your-data into production — directed architecture across orchestration, Cypher, and RAG agents; integrated TwelveLabs multi-modal AI.
- Delivered a production chatbot suite for studio workflows; lead use case saves 6.5 hours per person per week.
- Owned platform build-vs-buy — consolidated BI onto a single enterprise analytics stack (retired a legacy reporting vendor), and selected Snowflake Cortex + Neo4j over leading vector-search and RAG vendors for governance and Snowflake-native lineage.
- Delivered production ML forecasting and decision-support models for studio finance (cash flow, quarterly budget); contributor to the studios' cross-company finance transformation.
- Lead product managers with prior director-level experience across software, data, and visual effects; mentor 5 PMs beyond the immediate org; led multiple contractor-to-FTE conversions and several direct-report moves into expanded scope.

### Yum Brands | Taco Bell Portfolio Manager, Product, Data & Analytics Platform

January 2025 — June 2025

- 30+ person matrix team • all enterprise data products • 7,000+ operators and executives served
- Reduced platform incidents 85% (12→ 1–2 P1/P2 monthly) and increased satisfaction 50% in 60 days by converting a service team into a product organization — prioritization frameworks, transparent stakeholder communication, org-wide BI standards.
- Shipped reporting structure, governance frameworks, and Microsoft Fabric + Gen AI capabilities; partnered on AI drive-thru, digital menu boards, and Cantina launches.
- Delivered ML models for labor prediction and CRM, plus platform support for digital marketing and e-commerce.
- Expanded from CDP to the full platform portfolio after demonstrating rapid impact.

### Staff Product Manager, Enterprise Customer Data Platform

June 2023 — January 2025

- All Yum brands — Taco Bell, KFC, Pizza Hut • 14-person team across product, engineering, and analytics

- Drove CDP adoption across Taco Bell, KFC, and Pizza Hut — led implementation and GTM enabling 80% YoY loyalty growth (CDP contribution validated via marketing mix model).
- Shipped ML models and pipelines for retention, lapse prediction, and CRM insights; delivered intelligence to 7,000+ operators through in-store reporting, regional dashboards, and franchisee tracking.
- Moved the group from order-takers to a strategic product organization and increased satisfaction 40%.

## Capital Group Senior Product Manager, Data Platforms & Strategic Automation

August 2022 — June 2023

All Capital Group ETFs and Mutual Funds • roadmap across Marketing, Sales, and Compliance

- Launched the Phoenix Fire data platform 0→1 to 100% enterprise adoption — consolidated tools, automated workflows, and modern UX transformed sales and marketing operations.
- Shipped through 3 ETF launches while managing a unified roadmap across Marketing, Sales, and Compliance.
- Established a data governance framework with proactive quality monitoring and stakeholder notification, in a highly regulated context.

## Sprout Mortgage Manager, Analytics & Product Strategy

October 2021 — August 2022

Enterprise analytics function built from scratch • 85 sales professionals supported

- Built the enterprise analytics function from scratch — standardized reporting and drove a 15% loan origination increase across 85 sales professionals.
- Integrated Power BI with a custom CRM, delivering self-service analytics and pipeline visibility to 4 VPs, 10 regional managers, and 85 loan officers.

*Earlier: investment analysis and BI leadership at Pacific Urban Investors (2018–2021) and Civic Financial Services (2015–2018); began in commercial real estate acquisitions at Partners Capital (2015).*

## PRODUCTS BUILT INDEPENDENTLY

*Production software architected and shipped solo through AI coding tools.*

- **Allison's Kitchen** (allisonskitchen.app) — Household kitchen software. Recipe capture from a link, a photo, or a video; weekly meal planning; step-by-step cook mode. Built for one household first, now in invite-only release with families onboarding in batches; iOS build in UAT. Next.js + Supabase.
- **NexusWatch** (nexuswatch.dev) — Real-time geopolitical intelligence. 45+ live data layers across 86 countries (conflict, disasters, infrastructure, intelligence, environment), an LLM analyst synthesizing threat patterns, and an MCP server for AI agent access. Open source, paired with a daily geopolitical-risk brief with subscribers. Vite + TypeScript + MapLibre GL + Supabase + Claude API. Live since April 2026.
- **Altogether** (longtable.dev) — Multi-household trip planning. Households submit availability and budget privately; an AI co-planner reconciles them into workable windows and per-household costs. In development.
- **Prototype Studio** (zerotoship.app) — Working sessions, guides, and agent-system setup for PMs, analysts, and BI engineers shipping with AI coding tools. Live and usable today; active development on hold. Formerly Zero to Ship, which began as a structured course before becoming a services practice.

Also in development: **The Composer** (agentic editorial framework; a ten-persona editorial board gating a notes → draft → review → publish pipeline) and **Product OS** (spec-as-code for PMs; OSS CLI and PR-based spec workflows). Separately maintain a paper-traded systematic trading research platform with walk-forward evaluation and SEC EDGAR insider-signal modeling, with no real capital deployed.

## WRITING & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

**The Data Product Agent** (thedataproductagent.substack.com) — Data products, AI-native team operating models, multi-agent systems, and building enterprise software through AI coding tools.

## EDUCATION

**Loyola Marymount University** — B.B.A. in Finance and Economics

## CERTIFICATIONS

**AI Fundamentals for Non-Data Scientists** — University of Pennsylvania, Wharton (Credential ID: 9QM1CR10FD5F)

**Databricks Academy Accreditations** — Generative AI Fundamentals + Lakehouse Fundamentals (Credential IDs: 112741113, 112676552)